Xitian (Tina) Yu

tinayu191409@gmail.com | tinay14.github.io

Education

Cornell University — Ithaca, NY
Bachelor of Science in Nutritional Science; Minor in Business — Aug 2026 – present

Stony Brook University — Stony Brook, NY
Bachelor of Science in Biochemistry, Minor in Rhetoric and Writing — Aug 2025 – May 2026

Research Experience

Department of Biochemistry and Cell Biology (Dormant Biology Lab) — Stony Brook, NY
Undergraduate Student Researcher — Jan 2026 – Present

- Gain hands-on wet lab experience using African killifish, leveraging visual phenotypic readouts to connect genetic manipulations with observable phenotypic outcomes
- Participate in weekly lab meetings and contribute to discussions on killifish research

Cold Spring Harbor Laboratory — Cold Spring Harbor, NY
Volunteer Research Assistant — Jul 2024 – Feb 2025

- Conducted an independent research project investigating whether the Kolmogorov-Arnold Network (KAN) model could provide better interpretability compared to the SQUID framework for analyzing deep learning outputs in genomic sequences, with a focus on understanding cis-regulatory elements and their complex interactions
- Participated in weekly lab meetings and discussions on cis-regulatory elements while gaining dry lab experience

Leadership Experience

TeaTime @ Cornell — Aug 2026 – Present
Outreach Coordinator

- Manage and curate content for all official social media channels to expand campus engagement and brand visibility
- Design custom promotional graphics and marketing materials for club events and social campaigns
- Initiate and maintain external partnerships with local businesses to secure event sponsorships and collaborations

ProVeg International Food Innovation Challenge — Sep 2025 – Present
Campus Ambassador and Competitor

- Serve as group leader of an international team developing an original low-cost, fast-to-produce freeze-dried buckwheat porridge positioned as a reliable meal-replacement option for fat loss and muscle gain
- Lead campus-wide promotion and operations by recruiting and supporting student participants, organizing roadshow events, managing daily communications, and coordinating cross-functional team activities

TeddyBear Community — Apr 2024 – Jun 2025
Tutor, Outreach Team

- Taught weekly Nutrition and Living Environment courses to support student learning and academic growth
- Conducted outreach to childcare organizations to expand access to free online academic resources, increasing educational opportunities for underserved children

C-pop Dance Group at Syosset High School — Feb 2024 – Jun 2025
Founder and Captain

- Hosted dance learning workshops every alternate week to pursue members' interests in C-pop dances and help members gain a deeper understanding of Chinese pop dance culture
- Organized fundraisers and secured performance opportunities for the club, leading group dances and coordinating performances on school stages and in the local community

Supernova Model United Nations Team — Mar 2024 – Apr 2025
Director of Design

- Hosted weekly meetings, participated in events, and coordinated activities across 50+ members including summer international online Model United Nations debates
- Designed club logos, event posters, and certificate templates, and managed and assigned certificates to participants

National Honor Society at Syosset High School — Sep 2024 – Jun 2025
Treasurer

- Managed financial records and facilitated clear communication channels between 400+ members and advisors
- Fostered peer mentorship and guidance sessions, ensuring members' questions and concerns were addressed

Selected Honors

2025 The WAC Lighting Invitational Science Fair - Honorable Mention
2021-2025 Annual Honor Rolls (All Eligible Years)
2025 Nassau County High School Bowling Tournament - 2nd Place
2023-2024 Researcher of the Year
2023-2024 Congress Of Future Medical Leaders Award of Excellence
2022-2023 Badminton Coaches Award
2022-2023 Certificate of Merit in Athletics

Extracurricular Activities

SBU Eats at Stony Brook University Sep 2025 – Present

Volunteer

- Support weekly teaching kitchen sessions by assisting with food preparation, facilitating hands-on activities, and promoting practical nutrition education through interactive learning experiences
- Engage with students during school-wide nutrition events, assisting with event coordination, outreach, promotion, and photography to enhance program visibility and impact

Nutrition Facts Organization Aug 2023 – Present

Volunteer

- Edit and translate 150+ blogs, each reaching over 2,000+ reads, and help test a nutrition tracking app
- Attend nutrition-focused webinars and interact with renowned dietitian Dr. Greger to deepen field knowledge

American Society of Nutrition (ASN) Oct 2023 – Present

Member

- Participate in professional webinars to expand knowledge of current nutrition research and industry trends; engage with research dietitians to seek guidance for future career development
- Complete online continuing-education courses and earn 10+ AMA/CME credits with certification

Gardening Group at Stony Brook University Aug 2025 – Present

Member

- Support campus garden maintenance and plant health by removing weeds and managing pests
- Plant, maintain, and harvest vegetables, applying hands-on gardening techniques and utilizing fresh produce to prepare nutritious meals

Girls Varsity Bowling Team at Syosset High School Nov 2022 – Jun 2025

Senior Captain, Bowler

- Actively participated in team practices and competitive matches, developing technical bowling skills and game strategy while guiding new team members during practices, helping them build foundational skills and confidence

Projects

Wolfie Dine - SBU Dining Hall Menu Aggregator Jan 2026 – Present

- Developed a centralized menu aggregator website for Stony Brook University dining halls, allowing students to view all available meal options across multiple dining locations in one platform, reaching 5,000+ visitors

Sanitary Smart Gas Pump Design - Research Paper Sep 2023 – Jun 2024

- Proposed a Smart Service gas pump design featuring disposable recyclable plastic materials on the handle and an integrated AI service system to assist customers in avoiding direct contact with the pump

The Effect of Fluorescence in Energy Drinks - Research Paper Sep 2023 – Jun 2024

- Investigated the luminescent properties of energy drinks by analyzing samples with a spectrophotometer to measure maximum absorbance and corresponding wavelengths, producing comparative graphs with detailed analysis of fluorescence data

Skills

Computer Skills: Python, Canvas, Autodesk Sketchbook, Wevideo, Scratch, Google Slide/Doc/Form/Sites
Speaking Languages: Chinese (Native), French (Elementary proficiency), Spanish (Elementary proficiency)
Soft Skills: Communication Skills, Team Work, Critical Thinking, Adaptability, Problem Solving
Certificates: CPR/AED First Aid Certification